

Now that you've selected some firms to visit, what are you going to do when you get there? Remember, the broker is wondering what kind of agent you'll be. At the same time, you're trying to establish whether it's a brokerage that you'll be proud to name as yours.

As you walk into the firm, look around. Is it a place where you'd be proud to meet clients? Is it in a desirable neighborhood and location? Are staff members friendly and welcoming? How's the parking situation?

- Information about the firm
- Commission splits and other costs
- Training
- Lead generation
- Marketing
- Listing and contract technology
- Support
- Expectations

Talk to other licensees in the firm. Is this firm suitable for new licensees? Are brokers, coaches, or mentors available both during and outside regular office hours? Is the firm's broker approachable? Does he or she seem truly vested in the success of the associated licensees? Keep asking questions until you have a good feel for the office and its culture.